GLOUCESTER
ZAKAT FUND
CHARITY FOR LOCAL RESIDENTS

EQUALITY, DIVERSITY & INCLUSION POLICY

Document Information	
Policy Name	Equality, Diversity & Inclusion Policy
Version	1.0
Policy Owner	Board of Trustees
Approved by	Board of Trustees
Date Approved	01/02/2026
Next Review Date	01/02/2028
Related Policies	Safeguarding Policy, Complaints Policy, Volunteer Management Policy, Grant-Making Policy, Trustee Code of Conduct

1. Introduction

Gloucester Zakat Charity ("the Charity") is a Charitable Incorporated Organisation established to prevent and relieve poverty and financial hardship in Gloucestershire and the wider United Kingdom, with a particular focus on members of the Muslim community.

As a faith-based charity rooted in Islamic values, we believe in the inherent dignity and worth of every human being. The Islamic principle of equality is central to our work – Zakat (obligatory almsgiving) is distributed based on need, not on any other characteristic. Our faith teaches us that all people are equal before God and deserve to be treated with respect and compassion.

The Charity is committed to encouraging equality, diversity, and inclusion in all aspects of our work. We oppose unlawful discrimination and seek to ensure that everyone – beneficiaries, volunteers, trustees, donors, partners, and members of the public – is treated fairly and with dignity.

As a small volunteer-run charity with no paid staff, this policy is adapted to our context. It applies to all those who represent, work with, or benefit from the Charity.

2. Purpose

The purpose of this policy is to:

- Set out the Charity's commitment to equality, diversity, and inclusion
- Ensure compliance with the Equality Act 2010
- Promote fairness and respect for all in the delivery of our charitable services
- Ensure equality of opportunity in volunteer and trustee recruitment
- Oppose and prevent unlawful discrimination, harassment, and victimisation
- Make our services accessible to all who are eligible
- Foster a welcoming and inclusive environment

3. Legal Framework

3.1 The Equality Act 2010

The Equality Act 2010 provides protection against discrimination on the basis of certain "protected characteristics". The Charity is committed to not discriminating unlawfully against anyone on the basis of these protected characteristics.

3.2 Protected Characteristics

The protected characteristics under the Equality Act 2010 are:

- **Age**
- **Disability**
- **Gender reassignment**
- **Marriage and civil partnership**
- **Pregnancy and maternity**
- **Race** (including colour, nationality, and ethnic or national origin)
- **Religion or belief**
- **Sex**
- **Sexual orientation**

3.3 Types of Discrimination

The Charity will not engage in any of the following forms of unlawful discrimination:

Direct discrimination: Treating someone less favourably because of a protected characteristic.

Indirect discrimination: Applying a provision, criterion, or practice that disadvantages people with a protected characteristic, unless it can be objectively justified.

Harassment: Unwanted conduct related to a protected characteristic that violates dignity or creates an intimidating, hostile, degrading, humiliating, or offensive environment.

Victimisation: Treating someone unfavourably because they have made or supported a complaint about discrimination.

4. Scope

This policy applies to:

- All trustees of the Charity
- All volunteers
- Beneficiaries receiving Zakat, Sadaqah, or other charitable assistance
- Donors
- Partner organisations (GARAS, GMWA, GIT, GBA, and others)
- Speakers and event participants
- Anyone else who comes into contact with the Charity
- All activities carried out by or on behalf of the Charity

5. Our Commitments

Gloucester Zakat Charity is committed to:

- Creating an environment where everyone is treated with dignity and respect
- Ensuring our services are accessible and available to all eligible people
- Making decisions about charitable assistance based on need and eligibility, not on protected characteristics
- Providing equality of opportunity for volunteers and trustees
- Taking seriously any complaints of discrimination, harassment, or victimisation
- Working with partner organisations that share our commitment to equality and inclusion
- Celebrating the diversity of the communities we serve
- Regularly reviewing this policy and our practices to ensure they remain appropriate and effective

6. Equality in Service Delivery

6.1 Beneficiary Selection

The Charity distributes Zakat and Sadaqah funds to individuals in financial hardship. Decisions about who receives assistance are based on need and eligibility criteria, consistent with Islamic principles governing Zakat distribution. These decisions are not influenced by protected characteristics unrelated to eligibility.

We will:

- Assess applications for assistance based on financial need and eligibility
- Apply consistent criteria to all applicants
- Not discriminate unlawfully against any applicant

- Make reasonable adjustments to enable people with disabilities to access our services
- Document decisions and reasons to ensure transparency and accountability

6.2 Faith-Based Focus

While the Charity has a particular focus on members of the Muslim community (as stated in our charitable objects), we do not discriminate unlawfully on grounds of religion. The Charity may receive donations designated specifically for Muslim beneficiaries (particularly Zakat, which has specific requirements under Islamic law), and these funds will be distributed accordingly. General charitable funds and Sadaqah may be distributed more broadly based on need.

The Equality Act 2010 permits charities to restrict benefits to people who share a protected characteristic where this is a proportionate means of achieving a legitimate aim connected to the charity's purposes. The Charity will operate within these legal parameters.

6.3 Accessible Services

We will take reasonable steps to make our services accessible, including:

- Providing information in accessible formats on request
- Holding events in accessible venues where possible
- Offering alternative ways to apply for assistance for those who cannot complete written forms
- Being sensitive to language barriers and offering support as needed
- Considering the needs of different groups when planning events and activities

7. Equality in Volunteer and Trustee Recruitment

7.1 Volunteers

The Charity welcomes volunteers from all backgrounds. We will:

- Not discriminate unlawfully against anyone who wishes to volunteer
- Select volunteers based on their skills, experience, and suitability for the role
- Make reasonable adjustments to enable volunteers with disabilities to participate
- Treat all volunteers with dignity and respect
- Provide a welcoming and supportive environment

7.2 Trustees

The Charity seeks to build a Board of Trustees with diverse skills, perspectives, and experiences. We will:

- Not discriminate unlawfully in trustee recruitment
- Select trustees based on their skills, experience, commitment, and ability to contribute to the Charity's governance
- Encourage applications from people of different backgrounds
- Consider diversity when making trustee appointments, while ensuring all appointments are made on merit

As a Muslim charity, trustees are expected to understand and support the Charity's Islamic ethos and approach to Zakat distribution. This is an occupational requirement related to the Charity's religious character and is permitted under the Equality Act 2010.

8. Roles and Responsibilities

8.1 Board of Trustees

The Board of Trustees is responsible for:

- Approving this policy and ensuring it is implemented
- Setting an example of inclusive behaviour
- Considering equality, diversity, and inclusion in all decisions
- Handling complaints of discrimination appropriately
- Monitoring the implementation of this policy
- Reviewing the policy regularly

8.2 All Trustees and Volunteers

All trustees and volunteers must:

- Be familiar with this policy and act in accordance with it
- Treat everyone with dignity and respect
- Not engage in discrimination, harassment, or victimisation
- Report any concerns about discriminatory behaviour
- Support the Charity's commitment to equality and inclusion

9. Complaints

Any person who believes they have been discriminated against, harassed, or victimised by the Charity, its trustees, or volunteers should raise their concerns. Complaints will be taken seriously and investigated fairly.

Complaints should be made in accordance with the Complaints Policy. Complaints can be submitted by email to complaints@gloucesterzakat.org.uk or in writing to Gloucester Zakat Charity, 64 Salisbury Road, Gloucester GL1 4JQ.

The Charity will not tolerate victimisation of anyone who raises a genuine complaint about discrimination. Making a malicious or vexatious complaint is, however, a serious matter and may be treated as misconduct.

10. Partner Organisations

The Charity works with partner organisations including GARAS, GMWA, GIT, and GBA. We expect our partners to share our commitment to equality, diversity, and inclusion. When selecting partners and when entering into agreements, we will consider whether they operate in ways consistent with this policy.

11. Monitoring and Review

11.1 Monitoring

Where appropriate and proportionate to our size, the Charity will monitor:

- The diversity of beneficiaries assisted (in broad terms, to understand who we are reaching)
- Any complaints of discrimination received
- Accessibility of our services and events
- The composition of the Board of Trustees

This monitoring will be conducted in a way that respects privacy and data protection requirements.

11.2 Review

This policy will be reviewed by the Board of Trustees every two years, or sooner if:

- There are significant changes to equality legislation
- A complaint highlights gaps in the policy
- The Charity's activities change significantly
- The Board identifies a need for updates

12. Related Policies

This policy should be read in conjunction with:

- Safeguarding Policy
- Complaints Policy
- Volunteer Management Policy
- Grant-Making Policy
- Trustee Code of Conduct
- Data Protection Policy

13. Approval and Version History

Version	Date	Approved By	Changes
1.0	01/02/2026	Board of Trustees	Initial policy

14. Trustee Declaration

We, the undersigned trustees of Gloucester Zakat Charity, confirm that we have read, understood, and approved this Equality, Diversity & Inclusion Policy and commit to its implementation.

Name	Role	Signature	Date
Mr Abdullah Abdul Samad Patel	Chair	A. Patel	01/02/2026
Mr Kamel Boulkenafet	Trustee	K. Boulkenafet	01/02/2026
Mr Hashim Moolla	Trustee	H. Moolla	01/02/2026
Mr Farouq Ginwalla	Trustee	F. Ginwalla	01/02/2026
Ms Mariam Qureshi	Trustee	M. Qureshi	01/02/2026

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